

Mindfulness of Food and Eating

GUIDED MEDITATION SCRIPT

Date / Time:

So far today, have you brought kind awareness to your:

☐ Thoughts? ☐ Heart? ☐ Body? ☐ None

To begin this Meditation, please bring kind awareness to:

- why you chose this topic
- how your belly, chest, and head each feel when you reflect on this topic
- the emotions that you can associate with these visceral feelings
- the positive or negative impact of any stories you believe in regarding this topic
- the fact that many others are feeling similarly about this topic as you
- how you might feel with increased awareness around this topic
- when you can apply increased mindfulness to this topic in your day-to-day life



Mindful eating is an opportunity to nourish your body while deepening your mindfulness practice. In this short guided practice, you will bring your full attention to a small piece of food and to the process of eating it.

You can do this practice in any position conducive to eating and it is helpful to stay relatively still while eating. This minimizes unnecessary stimulus and helps you focus on the experience.

First, choose a small piece of food. You can do this with any food, but I recommend starting with something simple, like a raisin, a berry, or a piece of your favourite vegetable.

Begin by taking in the food visually. Notice its color, shape, and size.

Is the color uniform? Is there a pattern?

Is the shape regular or irregular? Just notice what you notice.

And as you look at this piece of food, notice any urge to start eating.

Is there hunger? Is there craving? Just allow the cravings to come and go as you investigate this food visually.

Next, investigate the smell of the food. Some foods may have stronger aromas than others and you may have to hold the food up to your nose to pick up a scent.

Be fully present for the experience of smelling.

If the mind begins to crave, just return to the smell in front of you.



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Now before eating this piece of food, take a brief moment to appreciate the energy that went into its production:

The people who worked to grow this food and bring it to you.
Nature that provided nutrients, rainwater, and sunshine.
Maybe somebody cooked, cleaned, or packaged it for you.

Bring into your mind to all of the energy from various sources that came together to create this meal.

Now, slowly pick up the food. If you are using any utensils, tune in to the experience of touch as you feel the utensil.

Mindfully feel how the food or utensil feels in your hand. Is it stiff, soft, cold, or warm?

As you put the food in your mouth, notice the desire to chew and swallow quickly. Instead, start by feeling the temperature of the food.

Holding the food in your mouth, can you feel the shape?

As you begin chewing, notice the texture of the food. Does it change as you continue to chew?

And then notice the flavors.

You may have a hard time doing more than simply labeling what you're eating, such as "It's a raspberry." But try to leave the label aside as you explore this piece of food as if for the first time.

Try to dig a little deeper. Are there multiple flavors present? Pay attention to the changing of flavors as you continue to chew.

When you swallow this first bite, tune in to the experience of swallowing. What does it feel like as the food moves down the throat?

You may also notice the desire to quickly have another bite. But first, pause and notice if any flavor remains in the mouth for a moment.

Then mindfully have another bite in the same way. Remind yourself to slow down and be present.

As you practice mindfulness of your food and eating, continue to check in with the sights, smells, tastes, feelings, and thoughts that arise.

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And when you finish eating, allow yourself to feel gratitude for the food that is nourishing your body. Let the mind relax into a state of appreciation for the energy this food provides.

